

DARROUGH WEST

UX Designer | Enterprise IT, Developer UX, Design Systems & Agile Delivery

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SUMMARY

Senior UX designer with 15+ years of experience designing enterprise IT products and developer-facing experiences in Agile environments, with deep expertise in **design systems, accessibility, user research, and technical user experience**. Strong track record of uncovering user needs through data analytics and usability research, translating insights into evidence-based design improvements for complex, large-scale platforms. Experienced designing for **technical users including developers, sysadmins, and platform engineers**, and contributing to enterprise design systems through new components, patterns, and usage guidelines. Builds cross-functional relationships, advocates for end users, and communicates design decisions clearly to both technical and non-technical stakeholders.

CORE SKILLS

- Enterprise IT Product Design & Complex Workflow UX for Technical Users
- UX Research: Usability Studies, Surveys, Interviews, Heuristic Assessments (Nielsen Norman)
- Data Analytics & Evidence-Based Design: Behavioral Analytics, KPI-Oriented Improvements
- Design Systems: Component Libraries, Design Tokens, Pattern Documentation & Governance
- High-Fidelity Prototyping & Interaction Design (Figma: Components, Auto-Layout, Variables)
- Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA, Screen Reader Technology) & Inclusive Design
- Agile Methodologies, Jira, Sprint Planning & Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Developer Experience (DX): API Usability, CLI/GUI Environments, Technical Onboarding
- Remote Facilitation, Digital Whiteboarding & Cross-Functional Ideation Sessions
- Design Communication: Technical & Non-Technical Presentations for Large and Small Audiences

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Figma (Expert: Components, Auto-Layout, Prototyping, Variables, Dev Mode), Miro, Jira, Confluence, Adobe Creative Suite, Algolia, Hotjar, JavaScript, React, HTML, CSS, Claude, ChatGPT, v0

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager, Web Development & Digital Workplace (Senior UX Designer)

Liberty Hardware | Winston-Salem, NC · June 2024 – June 2026

- Uncovered user needs, friction points, and opportunities through data analysis (Algolia search analytics, Hotjar heatmaps), generating and prioritizing insights and creating user journeys shared across the cross-functional team.
- Planned and produced enterprise IT products considering data limitations, resourcing, capabilities, and performance requirements, partnering with technical and operational stakeholders throughout delivery.
- Assisted in planning, executing, and analyzing usability studies to validate design understanding and uncover key gaps, identifying specific interaction failures through behavioral data and iterating on solutions.
- Contributed new components and patterns to the platform design system, improving consistency and scalability across digital properties.
- Built cross-functional relationships and communicated design decisions to both technical and non-technical audiences, advocating directly for end user needs in stakeholder discussions.
- Utilized Agile methodologies and project management tools for efficient delivery across multiple concurrent workstreams.
- **28% product page conversion lift, 41% mobile session duration increase, 92% reduction in friction-driven searches while growing traffic 6x.** Delivered measurable outcomes:

Principal UX Designer / UX Engineer

Fidelity Investments | Raleigh-Durham, NC · 2021 – 2024

- Co-led design and implementation of FDS, Fidelity's enterprise design system, building a component library with design tokens, variants, and usage documentation for 150+ designers and engineers across multiple product teams, shipped in 9 months.
- Identified gaps in the large enterprise design system and advocated for evolution through new components, patterns, and usage guidelines, documenting decisions to facilitate knowledge sharing and adoption.
- Conducted and supported usability research including studies and stakeholder interviews to inform design decisions across high-traffic financial B2B products.
- Led and engaged cross-functional teams in interactive sessions using digital whiteboarding tools to map user journeys, create wireframes, and prioritize features collaboratively.
- Collaborated in Agile environments with engineers, product managers, and stakeholders to ensure design concepts were translated into functional products.

Front-End Developer / UX Engineer

IBM | Raleigh-Durham, NC · 2017 – 2020

- Designed and built accessible, responsive interfaces aligned to the IBM Design System for enterprise IT products used by developers, sysadmins, and platform engineers, earning an Outstanding Technical Achievement Award (September 2019) and filing a first patent (September 2018).
- Designed for technical users in CLI and GUI environments, contributing to enterprise-scale design systems and ensuring consistency across a wide range of products and platforms.
- Collaborated in Agile teams with engineers and product managers, translating interaction design principles into functional, production-ready UI.
- Conducted large-scale heuristic assessments and contributed to open-source design system components.

Director of Development (UX + Front-End)

Pillar4 Media | Charlotte, NC · 2020 – 2021

- Led UX and front-end development for large enterprise content platforms, designing headless CMS experiences and API-driven frontend components for technical integrators and content operators.
- Designed technical onboarding experiences and operator workflows, improving usability and reducing integration friction for developer and partner teams.

Lead Creative Technologist

MullenLowe U.S. · 2015 – 2017

- Designed and developed interactive digital experiences for major brand campaigns, delivering non-linear and highly graphical user interface elements across web and mobile platforms.
- Bridged creative design and engineering, communicating design rationale to both technical and non-technical stakeholders across large cross-functional teams.

Director of Technology / UX Designer

Ignite Social Media · 2013 – 2015

- Led UX execution for social web applications and branded digital experiences, partnering with creative and strategy teams and advocating for user needs throughout product delivery.

UX Designer / Interactive Developer

Various Clients & Agencies · 2002 – 2013

- Designed and built interactive web experiences, applications, and browser-based games (Kellogg's, P&G via Biggs Gilmore), developing strong foundations in visual design, interaction, and front-end development.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- 15+ years designing for enterprise IT environments and technical user audiences including developers, sysadmins, and platform engineers
- Deep enterprise design system experience: component libraries, tokens, pattern documentation, and governance at scale (150+ designers at Fidelity)
- Strong accessibility practice: WCAG 2.1 AA, screen reader design, and inclusive UX standards embedded from the start
- Nielsen Norman heuristic evaluation methodology applied across large-scale product assessments
- IBM Outstanding Technical Achievement Award (September 2019) and first patent filed (September 2018)

EDUCATION

Associate Degree – Computer Graphics & Multimedia · Lansing Community College